

India is a land of great variety of natural vegetation. Himalayan heights are marked with temperate vegetation. The western ghats (Karnataka, Kerala, etc.) and the Andaman Nicobar Islands have tropical forests.

2. Dense-forests on the earth are mostly found –

- (a) Nearby Equator
- (b) Nearby tropic of Cancer
- (c) Nearby tropic of Capricorn
- (d) Nearby Poles

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

Tropical evergreen forests grow in the regions near the Equator (10°N-10°S). These regions are hot and receive heavy rainfall throughout the year. As there is no particular dry season, the trees do not shed their leaves altogether. This is the reason they are called evergreen. Three major regions of evergreen forest in the world are-

Amazon River Basin- Brazil, Bolivia, Peru, Ecuador, Colombia, Venezuela, French Guyana, Guyana, and Suriname.

Congo basin- Democratic Republic of Congo, Cameroon, Central African Republic, Gabon, Equatorial Guinea, Republic of the Congo.

Borneo- Mekong Southeast Asia basin–The region is composed of Two Sub region the Island of Borneo and the Mekong.

3. Which country of the world is the largest producer and exporter of soft timber and wood pulp?

- (a) U.S.A.
- (b) Norway
- (c) Sweden
- (d) Canada

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

During the period this question was asked, Canada was the leading country for production and export of softwood and wood pulp. According to the latest World Food and Agriculture Statistical yearbook 2023 (Data-2021), the United States is the top wood pulp producing country with 49685 million tonnes in 2021. Brazil, China, Canada, Sweden and Finland were at second, third, fourth and fifth place respectively.

The World Climate

1. Which one of the following forest fires/bushfires is not a Mediterranean climate type?

- (a) California
- (b) Turkey
- (c) Victoria
- (d) Siberia
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (d)

Siberia is not a Mediterranean Climate type. While California, Turkey and Victoria experience Mediterranean Climates characterized by hot, dry summers and mild, wet winters conducive to forest fires or bushfires, Siberia generally has a continental, climate with long, cold winters and short warm summers, which differs from the Mediterranean climate pattern.

2. In which of the following areas, Mediterranean climate does not prevail?

- (a) Central Chile
- (b) Cape Town
- (c) Adelaide
- (d) Pampas
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

Western part of Central Chile, Adelaide and Cape Town region have Mediterranean climate. The Pampas are fertile South American lowlands that cover more than 750,000 km² and include the Argentine province of Buenos Aries, La Pampa, Santa Fe, Entre Rios and Cordoba etc. all of Uruguay and the southernmost Brazillian state, Rio Grande do Sul. The climate is temperate with precipitation of 600 to 1200 mm. The climate is generally temperate, gradually giving away to more subtropical climate in the north and to a semi-arid climate on the western fringes.

3. Which of the following pair matching's is correct?

- (a) Mediterranean Sea Zone-Summer rain
- (b) Equatorial Zone-rain with thunder in the noon
- (c) Monsoon Zone-Heavy rain throughout the year
- (d) Desert zone- winter rain

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

The Mediterranean sea climatic region receives rainfall in winter.

In equatorial regions, convectional rain occurs with thunder at noon almost throughout the year. In Monsoon regions, the major rainfall is received by Monsoon winds. In Desert regions, rainfall is either negligible or indefinite. Hence, the correctly matched pair is option (b).